

KYLE GAARDER

Product Manager | Housing Innovation | Experimentation

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SUMMARY

Product-minded housing operator who has designed, tested, and iterated on residential products. I bring hands-on experience in the housing industry - launching a coliving product from zero, running pricing experiments, and building retention systems. My approach combines deep housing knowledge with rapid product experimentation and data-driven decision making.

For Homeward: I bring hands-on housing product experience — launched a residential product from zero, ran pricing experiments, and built retention systems that worked.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
- A/B tested dynamic pricing and stay-length diversification, driving 48% annual revenue increase
- Maintained 94% occupancy for 19 months through product iteration and resident experience design
- Built onboarding, engagement, and retention systems supporting long-term resident satisfaction
- Ran 48 community programs, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade initiatives driving engagement
- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY through housing ops optimization
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House while maintaining resident continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots outreach and validation
- Conducted 48 customer interviews to guide housing product-market fit and positioning
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led housing product development across strategy, ops, and concept validation

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎 **Housing Product from Zero**
Designed and launched residential product from concept to full occupancy in 2 weeks
- 💎 **48% Revenue via Experiments**
A/B tested pricing and engagement models driving 48% annual revenue growth
- 💎 **94% Occupancy for 19 Months**
Product-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months in emerging market
- 💎 **Investor Pilot Secured**
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new housing concept across 5 states
- 💎 **Demand Pipeline Built**
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

Housing Product Strategy

Rapid Experimentation

Pricing & Revenue Models

Resident Experience Design

Customer Research Interviews

Data-Driven Decisions A/B Tests

Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science,
Biology

Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014

📍 Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA

3.5 / 4.0